



Leadership for team building

Just as generals have to get the best from their troops, so business leaders must make the most of their teams. The key is ensuring that individuals work together to achieve a common goal.

How it works

From statesmen such as former British prime minister Winston Churchill to former General Electric CEO Jack Welch, great leaders know that to achieve a long-term goal, they must not only use their own capabilities but also maximize the combined strength of other people.

They have a passion that sweeps people along with them; they learn from mistakes and are prepared to alter their course to meet changing circumstances. Much academic work has been done to study the traits and strategies of such leaders.

How leaders inspire their teams

Academic Carl Larson and organizational effectiveness expert Frank LaFasto conducted a three-year study of more than 75 diverse teams. They identified six characteristics of leadership that steer a team toward optimum results.

“Leadership is the art of getting someone else to do something you want done because he wants to do it.”

Dwight D. Eisenhower



Focusing on goal

- › Defines goal in clear and inspirational way
- › Helps each team member see how they contribute to goal
- › Does not play politics



Encouraging collaboration

- › Allows open discussions
- › Demands and rewards collaboration
- › Involves and engages people



Building confidence

- › Accentuates the positive
- › Shows trust by assigning responsibility
- › Says “thank you”

